

Editorial

Dear Readers,

Chennai is definitely very lucky for us!

In the last issue, I had mentioned that we were expecting some great support from Chennai, but once again, the response from the city far exceeded our expectations.

We could feel the 'lucky city' factor right from the start. Just a week before the event, we received a call confirming that Dr Debesh Das, Minister, Department of IT, West Bengal, had accepted our invitation to deliver the inaugural address. The honourable minister came, he spoke, and he impressed all of us with what West Bengal has done with respect to utilising FOSS for the benefit of the state.

The second sign of good fortune was the number of attendees waiting to register even before the registration counter opened and that too, on a Sunday! In fact, the queues grew so long that all of us (including myself) had to man the registration desk to make sure that everyone was inside the hall, before the inauguration began.

What followed were a series of parallel tracks—many of them packed to the hilt. The only exceptions were the two 700-seat halls, which we hope will wear the 'House Full' tag next year. Even the 'hard to get an audience' sessions like the 'IT Managers track' and the 'CXO Summit' were well attended.

The final figures looked something like this. 60-plus speakers; over 2000 attendees; more than 16,000 fans on Facebook; 800 great photographs and 150 GB of video footage!

By the time we all got together for the Networking Dinner on the last night (21st September), we had aching feet, but big smiles on our faces. After all, nothing beats

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the feeling of having made a difference—after putting in a lot of hard work.

We owe our thanks to the sponsors, speakers, and all the attendees for making the show a hit. We also thank the entire OSSCube team for helping us take the content to a higher level. Last but not the least, we thank Chennai.

Since the current issue was scheduled to go to press just three days after OSI ended, we did not have the luxury of writing about everything that happened. Instead, since a picture is worth a thousand words, we have show-cased the entire event through a photo-spread on Page 22.

Any guesses on where the next edition of Open Source India will be?*

Best wishes,



Rahul Chopra

Editor, *LINUX For You*

On behalf of the entire OSI Days and the *LINUX For You* team

*Hint: Our lucky city.